PHASE 1 – BRAINSTORMING & IDEATION

Project Title

Streamlining IT Procurement: Automating Standard Laptop Orders

1. Introduction

In modern organizations, laptops and computers are essential tools for employees to perform their daily tasks. Whenever a new employee joins an organization or an existing employee requires a new laptop, a request has to be submitted to the IT department.

In a traditional IT procurement process, laptop requests are handled manually. Employees submit their requests, and the IT support or procurement team reviews the request, verifies the employee's requirements, checks availability, obtains approval, and processes the order.

When the number of employees and laptop requests increases, managing these requests manually becomes difficult. IT teams may spend a significant amount of time performing repetitive activities such as checking request details, verifying standard specifications, updating records, communicating with procurement teams, and tracking order status.

To overcome these challenges, the proposed project focuses on automating the standard laptop ordering process. The system will identify standard laptop requirements and automatically process eligible requests based on predefined rules and organizational policies.

The proposed solution aims to make IT procurement faster, more organized, standardized, and easier to track.

2. Problem Statement

In a traditional IT procurement environment, employees submit laptop requests through emails, forms, tickets, or other communication channels. The IT team then manually reviews every request before proceeding with procurement.

The IT team may need to receive the request, verify employee information, check requested specifications, determine whether the request follows the standard configuration, check availability, obtain approval, forward the request to procurement, update status, track progress, and communicate with the employee.

Performing these activities manually for every request can increase workload and may result in inconsistent processing.

Major Problems Identified

2.1 Delays in Laptop Procurement

Manual verification and approval processes can take considerable time. Employees may have to wait for

the IT team to review and process their requests.

2.2 Repeated Manual Work

IT employees repeatedly perform similar activities for every laptop request, such as checking employee details, verifying specifications, updating records, and communicating with other teams.

2.3 Data Entry Errors

When information is entered manually into different systems or records, there is a possibility of incorrect or missing information.

2.4 Difficulty in Tracking Requests

When requests are handled through emails, spreadsheets, or separate systems, it can become difficult to identify the current status of a particular laptop request.

2.5 Lack of Standardization

Different employees may request different laptop specifications even when their job roles require only a standard configuration.

2.6 Increased IT Workload

The IT support team has to spend time on repetitive procurement-related tasks instead of focusing on technical support.

2.7 Communication Issues

Manual communication between employees, IT support, procurement, and approval teams can result in missed updates or delays.

2.8 Lack of Centralized Information

If request details, approvals, procurement information, and delivery updates are stored in different locations, obtaining complete information becomes difficult.

3. Proposed Solution

The proposed project introduces an automated system for handling standard laptop requests.

The system will provide a structured process through which an employee can submit a laptop request. Once the request is submitted, the system can automatically validate the request based on predefined organizational rules.

For example, the organization can define a standard laptop configuration including a standard processor, RAM, storage, operating system, warranty, and accessories.

When an employee submits a request that matches the predefined standard configuration, the system can identify it as a standard request and automatically move it through the appropriate workflow.

The system can also maintain the request status throughout the procurement process.

Proposed Automated Workflow

Employee submits request → System validates employee and request details → System checks standard laptop requirements → Approval / automated processing → Procurement team receives request → Laptop order is processed → Delivery status is updated → Employee receives laptop → Request is completed

4. Main Objective

The primary objective of this project is to automate and simplify the procurement of standard laptops within an organization.

1. **Automate standard laptop ordering:** Reduce the amount of manual work required to process standard laptop requests.

2. **Reduce processing time:** Automatically validate and route eligible requests so that they can be processed faster.

3. **Minimize human errors:** Use predefined rules and structured forms to reduce incorrect or missing information.

4. **Standardize laptop requests:** Ensure that standard laptop configurations are consistently followed.

5. **Improve request tracking:** Allow employees and IT teams to view the current status of a laptop request.

6. **Reduce IT workload:** Automate repetitive tasks so IT employees can focus on other responsibilities.

7. **Improve communication:** Provide automatic notifications or status updates.

8. **Improve procurement efficiency:** Create a structured connection between employees, IT support, approval teams, and procurement.

9. **Maintain centralized records:** Store request details and procurement information centrally.

10. **Improve transparency:** Make it easier to identify who submitted a request, when it was submitted, approval status, and procurement stage.

5. Target Users

5.1 Employees

Employees can submit laptop requests, select a standard laptop, provide required information, view request status, receive updates, and track expected delivery.

5.2 IT Support Team

The IT support team can review requests, verify employee information, handle exceptions, monitor progress, and assist employees.

5.3 Procurement Team

The procurement team can receive approved requests, check availability, process purchase orders, update procurement status, and provide delivery information.

5.4 IT Administrators

IT administrators can configure standard laptop specifications, define procurement rules, manage users and permissions, monitor requests, generate reports, and maintain the system.

6. Key Features of the Proposed System

6.1 Employee Request Form

The form may contain employee name, employee ID, department, job role, laptop type, required configuration, business justification, required date, and additional comments.

6.2 Standard Laptop Catalog

The system can maintain a predefined catalog of approved standard laptops.

Example Standard Laptop Configuration

Specification	Standard Configuration
Processor	Intel Core i5 / equivalent
RAM	16 GB
Storage	512 GB SSD
Operating System	Windows
Warranty	Standard warranty
Accessories	Standard accessories

The exact specifications can be changed according to the organization's requirements.

6.3 Automatic Validation

After submission, the system can automatically check whether the request follows the standard configuration. If it matches the defined criteria, it can proceed through the standard workflow.

6.4 Approval Workflow

If organizational policy requires approval, the system can automatically send the request to the appropriate manager or IT approver.

6.5 Procurement Processing

Once approved, the request can be automatically forwarded to the procurement team.

6.6 Status Tracking

The system can maintain statuses such as Submitted, Under Review, Pending Approval, Approved, Sent to Procurement, Ordered, Shipped, Delivered, Completed, and Rejected.

6.7 Notifications

Automatic notifications can be sent when requests are submitted, approved, rejected, ordered, shipped, or delivered.

6.8 Reporting

The system can generate reports for total requests, approved requests, pending requests, completed requests, rejected requests, average processing time, and procurement status.

7. Basic System Workflow

Step 1 – Request Submission: The employee submits a laptop request through the system.

Step 2 – Request Validation: The system verifies whether all mandatory information has been provided.

Step 3 – Standard Configuration Check: The system compares the requested configuration with the predefined standard.

Step 4 – Approval: If approval is required, the request is sent to the appropriate approver.

Step 5 – Procurement: After approval, the request is transferred to procurement.

Step 6 – Order Processing: The procurement team processes the laptop order.

Step 7 – Delivery: The laptop is delivered to the employee.

Step 8 – Request Completion: After delivery, the request is marked completed and stored for tracking and reporting.

8. Expected Benefits

For Employees: Faster request processing, easy submission, better visibility, automatic updates, and fewer follow-ups.

For IT Support: Reduced repetitive work, easier request management, centralized information, improved tracking, and fewer manual errors.

For Procurement Team: Clear and standardized requests, better visibility of approved orders, easier order management, and improved tracking.

For the Organization: Reduced procurement delays, standardized configurations, better resource utilization, improved efficiency, centralized data, and better reporting.

9. Expected Outcome

The expected outcome is an automated and organized IT laptop procurement system.

The system will provide a structured process for employees to request standard laptops and allow eligible requests to move through predefined procurement workflows.

The project is expected to reduce manual processing, improve request processing speed, reduce data entry errors, standardize laptop configurations, improve request visibility, reduce IT workload, improve communication, provide centralized records, and improve overall procurement efficiency.

10. Future Scope

Possible future enhancements include automatic inventory checking, integration with asset management systems, integration with purchase order systems, integration with vendor systems, automatic price comparison, budget validation, advanced analytics and dashboards, AI-based request classification, automatic identification of non-standard requests, mobile application support, and automated laptop assignment and asset tracking.

11. Conclusion

The proposed “Streamlining IT Procurement: Automating Standard Laptop Orders” project focuses on improving the traditional laptop procurement process through automation.

By introducing standardized request forms, automated validation, approval workflows, procurement processing, status tracking, and notifications, the system can reduce repetitive manual activities and improve the overall efficiency of IT procurement.

The proposed solution provides a structured approach that benefits employees, IT support teams, procurement teams, and IT administrators. It also creates opportunities for future integration with inventory, asset management, vendor, and analytics systems.

Overall, the project aims to transform standard laptop procurement from a manual and time-consuming process into a more organized, transparent, and automated workflow.